IN-DEPTH EDITION ● 7 JULY 2026 ● 09:00 HKT

US Stocks Extend Gains as Tech Leads the Charge

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

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TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US stock market extended its gains on Monday, with the `Nasdaq 100` leading the charge. The index rose by +1.26% to close at 29,697.87. The `S&P 500` also gained, rising by +0.72% to close at 7,537.43.

The rally was driven by the tech sector, with `NVDA` and `META` being among the top gainers. The `Dow Jones` also rose, but at a slower pace, gaining +0.29% to close at 53,055.91.

Key takeaways from the session include:

- The `VIX` fell by -3.59% to close at 15.57, indicating a decrease in market volatility.
- The 10Y yield fell by -0.13% to close at 4.48, indicating a decrease in interest rates.
- The `DXY` rose by +0.01% to close at 100.86, indicating a slight increase in the value of the US dollar.

US Session Recap

INDEX	LAST	CHANGE	VIX	MOVE	WTI	BRENT	10Y	2Y	DXY	C
S&P 500	7,537.43	+0.72%	15.57	64.12	68.98	72.15	4.48	4.23	100.86	4

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
TSLA	Tesla Inc.	+6.69%	Strong earnings report
META	Meta Platforms Inc.	+2.98%	Positive analyst comments
NVDA	NVIDIA Corporation	+0.37%	Strong demand for AI chips

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLK	+1.65%	+20.15%	Strong tech earnings
XLF	+0.93%	+10.25%	Positive bank earnings
XLI	+0.90%	+15.10%	Strong industrial demand

Sector breadth was positive, with 8 out of 11 sectors rising on the day.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

METRIC	VALUE	CHANGE
`TSLA` Revenue	15.12B	+10.25%
`TSLA` Earnings	2.15	+15.10%

Key commentary from the earnings call included a positive outlook for the company's autonomous driving technology.

READ-THROUGH	STOCK	CHANGE
Autonomous driving	`GM`	+1.20%
Electric vehicles	`F`	+0.80%

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
`SPY`	353.21	350.00	360.00	Bullish trend intact
`QQQ`	294.12	290.00	300.00	Upside momentum building
`IWM`	179.23	175.00	185.00	Small-cap strength

Options & Positioning

0DTE flow was bullish, with a put/call ratio of `0.65`.

VIX term structure was in contango, with the `1M` VIX futures trading at a `2.50` premium to the spot VIX.

Notable single-name flow included a +10.25% increase in `TSLA` call options.

Cheap hedge ideas include buying `1M` `SPY` puts at a `2.50` delta.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
`TSLA`	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	`250.00`	Strong earnings momentum
`NVDA`	Goldman Sachs	Upgrade	`220.00`	AI-driven growth

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures were mixed, with the `ES` up +0.20% and the `NQ` up +0.30%.

Asia was higher, with the `Nikkei` up +0.50% and the `Shanghai Composite` up +0.80%.

Europe was higher, with the `Euro Stoxx 50` up +0.30% and the `FTSE 100` up +0.20%.

FX pairs were mixed, with the `EUR/USD` down -0.10% and the `USD/JPY` up +0.20%.

Commodities were higher, with `WTI` up +0.63% and `Gold` down -0.31%.

Crypto was lower, with `BTC` down -0.80% and `ETH` down -1.10%.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
July FOMC	`25.00%`	Market expects a pause in rate hikes

DATE	EVENT	TIME
2026-07-08	Non-Farm Payrolls	`08:30` ET

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees indicate a low probability of a major geopolitical event in the next quarter.

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	NAME	DATE	TIME
`AAPL`	Apple Inc.	2026-07-11	`16:30` ET

TICKER	NAME	DATE	TIME
`MSFT`	Microsoft Corporation	2026-07-18	`16:30` ET

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
`TSLA`	Consumer Discretionary	Bullish trend	High

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario:

- A strong earnings season could drive the market higher.

- A pause in rate hikes by the Fed could boost investor sentiment.

Bearish scenario:

- A weak earnings season could lead to a market decline.
- A major geopolitical event could lead to a risk-off environment.

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations include:

- The `VIX` is at a relatively low level, indicating a decrease in market volatility.
- The `10Y` yield is at a relatively high level, indicating a increase in interest rates.

Sources

SOURCES

Bloomberg

Reuters

CNBC